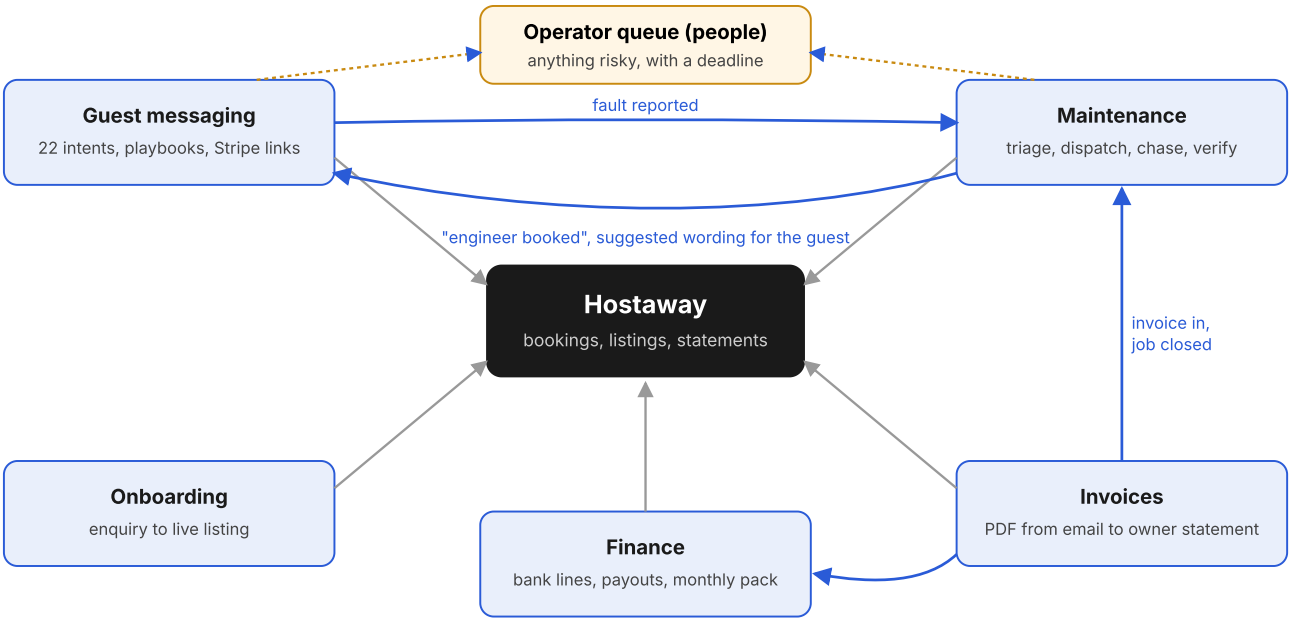
# How my short-let agent system worked

Harry Beaumont. Five agents I designed, built and ran for a short-let business across Nottingham, Leicester and Derby (68 properties at the time).




## ONE JOB END TO END: A GUEST REPORTS NO HOT WATER

Guest messaging reads the message, sees a fault, and passes it to Maintenance with the property and whether a guest is in. Maintenance raises the priority because the house is occupied, checks the same fault hasn't been fixed there in the last 14 days, picks the plumber, sends the access details and chases if there's no reply. Each update goes back to Guest messaging, which keeps the guest informed. Once fixed, the guest is asked to confirm. When the plumber's invoice arrives by email, the Invoices agent reads the PDF, matches it to the property and posts the cost to the owner's statement, which closes the job.

## WHERE THE AGENTS HAD TO STOP

- Complaints, damage, refunds, safety, legal or police mentions always went to a person.
- Below 80% confidence on what a guest wanted, a person decided.
- Repairs approved automatically up to £100, with the owner told up to £500, and quotes only above that.
- Guest compensation capped. Price changes over 30% needed my sign-off.
- No proactive messages overnight. Every send checked first so nothing went twice.

## HOW I KEPT IT RUNNING

- Each agent ran on schedules (every 5 to 30 minutes) and webhooks, and logged every action to a tracker.
- Messages between agents used one shared format with a secret, and anything without it was rejected.
- New versions ran in shadow mode first, drafting replies without sending them.
- A daily 6pm digest of what each agent had done and what needed me.
- A written state document for each agent, so anyone could see how it worked.

## WHAT I'D CHANGE NEXT TIME

Google Apps Script kept running costs close to zero, but its run-time limits and storage caps would not have coped much beyond 300 properties. Most outages came from API tokens expiring with no automatic refresh. Next time I'd run it as a proper service with token refresh and alerting built in from day one.

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Built with: Google Apps Script, Claude API, Hostaway API, Stripe, Twilio, Gmail and Google Sheets. Alongside the agents: a pricing engine for 68 properties (Next.js), an ElevenLabs voice agent on the phone line and an ops dashboard on Vercel.